ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE P

Measure P raises Fairfield's sales tax by up to one cent per dollar "until ended by voters." The City promises funding for police, fire, and streets, but the money goes into the general fund with no spending guarantees.

A higher sales tax increases the cost of everyday necessities. Families pay more for basic items, making daily life more expensive at a time when inflation is already high.

Fairfield already collects a local sales tax that was supposed to stabilize essential services. Instead of managing existing revenues responsibly, the City now seeks to raise the rate again, indefinitely. Measure P removes the previous sunset clause, meaning this tax could continue forever unless voters later repeal it. Ending this tax would require a new ballot initiative and thousands of signatures collected, a process so difficult that few communities ever succeed. Once enacted, it becomes a permanent tax with no expiration date**.**

The measure's language is broad and unrestricted. Funds go into the City's general fund, where they can be spent on any purpose the City Council chooses. There is no requirement that the money be used for police, fire, or street repair. Promises of "independent citizen oversight" and "annual audits" sound reassuring, but those mechanisms already exist and have not prevented questionable spending decisions in the past.

Fairfield's projected $24 million in new annual revenue is significant. Before asking residents to pay higher prices on every purchase, the City should demonstrate how previous tax dollars were used and what efficiencies have been achieved. Measure P offers no plan for fiscal reform, no spending priorities, and no end date.

Fairfield families and businesses deserve transparency, accountability, and responsible budgeting, not another permanent tax disguised as a temporary fix.

Vote NO on Measure P.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael Nolan, President